

Warren Township High School District 121

Board Agreements

1. Board member expectations

- a. Board members will strive to work together and assume positive intentions on the part of other board members. Exercise courtesy by discussing concerns in advance of meetings.

2. Agenda development

- a. Board members may contact the board president to place an item on the agenda.
- b. Prior to the board meeting, the board president will confer with the superintendent on the agenda.

3. Board member request for information

- a. Board members will read the board packet in advance of the meeting and contact the superintendent with any questions about items on the agenda. Board members will ask questions **prior** to the board meeting.
- b. Board members have a right to ask those questions **at** the meeting as well.
- c. Board members will self-monitor to ensure their request for information does not divert an inappropriate amount of time from staff efforts to achieve district goals.
- d. If a board member's request is estimated to take more than 30 minutes of staff time to prepare the information, the request will go to the full board for consensus.
- e. One member's request for additional information results in all members receiving or having the same access to the information. ("One gets, all get.")

4. Board members' communication via email

- a. Board members will be judicious in their use of email and understand that most emails are subject to the Freedom of Information Act and as such can be made public.
- b. In compliance with the Open Meetings Act, board members will not "reply all" to any district email.
- c. Board members will not email other board members stating their thoughts or opinions.

5. Communicating with staff

- a. Board members will keep the superintendent in the loop when communicating with other staff members.
- b. Board members communicating with staff in their role as parents will remember the neon sign that reads "BOARD MEMBER" and will not overstep their parent role.

6. Concerns from the community and staff ("Customer" concerns)

- a. When hearing a concern or complaint from a community member or staff member, board members will listen carefully and remember they are only hearing one side of the story.

- b. Board members will direct a community member or staff member with a concern to the most appropriate person in the district to help them resolve their concern.
- c. Board members will clarify that one board member has no individual authority to fix a problem.
- d. Board members will call the superintendent for information or clarification regarding community or staff concerns.

7. Communicating with the media

- a. The board president is the spokesperson for the board to the media.
- b. The superintendent is the spokesperson for the district to the media.

8. Closed session meetings

- a. Board members respect the confidentiality of privileged information and will not divulge conversations, discussions, or deliberations that take place during a closed session meeting.
- b. Board members understand that to divulge closed session information damages the relationship of the team and could have far-reaching consequences which may impact district operations.

9. Board meetings

- a. Board members will model the behaviors expected of students, staff, and community members.
- b. Board members have an obligation to express their opinions and respect others' opinions.
- c. Board members have the right to disagree with the decision of the board, but will support the board in its decision and abide by the will of the majority.
- d. Discussions and critiques will focus on issues, not individual people.
- e. Members will listen respectfully to each other and staff (no side conversations).

10. Social Media

- a. Board members recognize that while we may be giving our individual opinion or stating a fact on social media, it has the potential to impact the entire board.
- b. No more than two board members shall comment or post on a matter that is related to the operations and/or issues within our school district.
- c. When more than two board members are “tagged” by community members on a matter that is a current or a potential district issue, remove yourself (or ask to have yourself removed) from that conversation to avoid the appearance of any Open Meeting Act violations.

These agreements reflect policies 2:120 Board Member Development, 2:140 Communication To and From the Board, and 2:200 School Board Meeting Procedure